

County Administration Workshop: April 23, 2026

1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron Smith; Colene Martin; Gary Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Human Resources

1. Personnel Requisitions

a. Web and Information Coordinator, Refill Vacated Position, Vacant Since March 4, 2025

Michelle Shaw, Human Resource Director presented a request to refill the Web and Information Coordinator position, which has been vacant since March 2025 following voluntary resignation. Ms. Shaw explained that during the vacancy, responsibilities for public information requests, website updates, and communication functions have been distributed among multiple departments, including the Board of Commissioners' Office. Staff indicated that this has created operational strain and delays in responding to public records requests. The Board discussed the importance of restoring the position to ensure timely processing of public information requests, improve public communication, and centralize responsibilities related to web and media coordination.

2. Personnel Actions

a. Web and Information Coordinator, Refill Vacated

The Board discussed the proposed wage step for the selected candidate. Staff recommended a higher placement step based on the candidate's prior experience performing similar work in another jurisdiction. Commissioners expressed concern regarding consistency with advertised salary ranges and emphasized the importance of conducting salary analysis prior to recruitment. Discussion included ensuring fairness to other applicants and maintaining transparency in compensation practices. Following discussion, the Board reached consensus to move forward with the proposed candidate and compensation level, with directions to staff to improve consistency in future recruitment and salary analysis processes.

3. BOARD BUSINESS

a. Josephine County Budget Committee Applications

Ruth Nelson, Finance Director, provided background on the Budget Committee appointment process, including the need to correct prior term assignments to comply with statutory requirements for staggered terms. The Board discussed the applicant pool and the importance of selecting individuals with varied experience and perspectives to strengthen budget oversight and decision-making. The Board also discussed the importance of properly tracking staggered terms moving forward and creating clear position designations to ensure compliance with statutory requirements.

Commissioner Richardson made a motion to appoint Mark Kirby to a 3 year term, Chris Collins to a 2 year term, Dorothy Yetter 1 year term to the Josephine County Budget Committee. Seconded by Commissioner Smith. Upon Roll Call: Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

4. OTHER

a. Letter of Support for BJA FY25 Adult Treatment Court Program. The Board reviewed a request to provide a letter of support for the BJA FY25 Adult Treatment Court Program. *The Board Approved without Objection*

5. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:

Commissioners expressed appreciation for applicants to the Budget Committee and acknowledged the importance of public participation in County processes.

The meeting adjourned at 2:18 p.m.